(***avidya***) as human misconception (*mithya-jnana*) and our innate tendency to confuse (***adhyasa***) the true self and what it is not, *Padmapada* maintained that it is the cause of misconception and superimposition. He described ***avidya*** as a material (*jada*) force that is the underlying cause of the world-appearance. ***Avidya*** veiled the intact nature of ***Brahman*** and in association with the workings of ***karma*** and memory traces of previous cognitions produced the illusion of limited selfhood that is the substrate of individual experience and agency. He thought that the limited self is a finite reflection (*pratibimba*) of ***Brahman***.

Further reading: Halbfass 1995; Potter 1981

Paksha: the subject in an inference. It is the problematic case under consideration. When we wonder whether there is fire (***sadhya***) on the mountain, the mountain is the *paksha*. We notice that there is smoke (***hetu***) on the mountain and remember the generalisation, 'wherever there is smoke, there is fire'. This may be supported by similar and dissimilar instances: the kitchen (***sapaksha***) where smoke and fire invariably co-occur and the lake (***vipaksha***) that never harbours fire and never sees smoke, although the morning mist rising from it may sometimes have wrongly suggested otherwise.

Further reading: Ganeri 2001b

Paramartha-sat (ultimate reality/truth): reality as it is in itself, objective in the sense that it is independent of finite observers and their thoughts.

Basic to Buddhism is a distinction between objective reality (absolute truth) and conventional reality that is a matter of human experience (***vyavahara***, *samvriti*, *prajnapti*). It is undeniable that we have a sense of ourselves as embodied experiencers and agents with a history, a now, and future expectations. We may always feel that we are